

Step-by-step reintroduction protocol for suddenly aggressive cats based on Jackson Galaxy methods - with troubleshooting for redirected aggression triggers — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE | GENERATED MAY 12, 2026

MAP THE TIMELINE

- ☐ **Map the Timeline:** Write down the exact date and time you last saw your cats grooming each other, eating together, or sleeping peacefully without any tension or fear signals.
- ☐ **Map the Timeline:** Document precisely when you first witnessed aggression between the cats, including whether there was an external event happening at the same time like a noise or visitor.
- ☐ **Map the Timeline:** Track how the aggression evolved over the following hours and days, noting which cat initiated attacks and how the victim's behavior changed in response.
- ☐ **Map the Timeline:** Create a daily schedule showing each cat's current location, food access, litter box use, and stress signals to establish a clear baseline for recovery.

FIND THE TRIGGER

- ☐ **Find the Trigger:** Check all windows and doors for outdoor cats, wildlife, or anything visible outside that could have startled one cat into a reactive state.
- ☐ **Find the Trigger:** Review recent activities like veterinary visits, handling other cats, or returning from places where cats were present that could have left unfamiliar scent traces.
- ☐ **Find the Trigger:** Identify environmental changes such as new furniture, air fresheners, cleaning products, carpet fresheners, or rearranged furniture that may have disrupted your cats' territory.
- ☐ **Find the Trigger:** Schedule a veterinary examination for both cats to rule out pain, illness, or injury as an underlying cause of sudden behavioral changes and aggression.

PREPARE THE SETUP

- ☐ **Prepare the Setup:** Establish complete separation with a solid door barrier between the cats, providing each with their own food bowl, litter box, bed, and hiding spots in different rooms.
 - ☐ **Prepare the Setup:** Remove or completely block access to the original trigger source whether it is a window where outdoor cats are visible, a noisy appliance, or an unfamiliar scent.
 - ☐ **Prepare the Setup:** Plug Feliway diffusers into rooms where the cats spend most of their time and use an enzymatic cleaner on all areas where fighting occurred to break down fear-triggering scent markers.
 - ☐ **Prepare the Setup:** Allow both cats a minimum decompression period of several days to a week with no visual contact or forced interactions before beginning any reintroduction exercises.
-

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.